Fat Soluble Vitamins

Vitamin-A

The chemical name is Retinol. Found in foods of both plant and animal origin.

Daily requirements: 0.4-1 mg

Sources

Green leafy vegetables and yellow orange fruits and vegetables like mango, papaya, pumpkins and carrots are good sources of β-carotene.

Butter, whole milk, egg, liver and fish are richest sources.



Functions

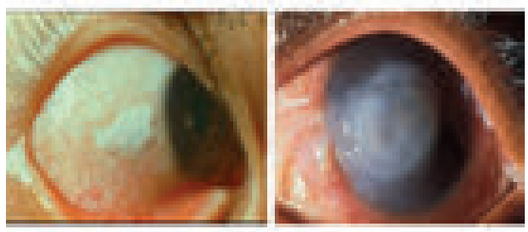
- Necessary for the health of the eyes.
- Maintenance of the normal epithelial tissues of the body.
- Necessary for growth and proper utilization of protein



Vitamin A deficiency is one of the major causes of blindness in India.

Deficiency Syndrome

- Decreased resistance to infection
- Dry scaly skin
- Night blindness (Inability to see in dim light)
- Xerophthalmia- dry eye
- Bitot's spots- Greyish, rough and raised patches on conjunctiva
- Keratomalacia- Softening of the cornea.
- Stunted Growth



Bitot's spot Keratomalacia



The states badly affected by Vitamin A deficiency are the southern and eastern states of INDIA are Andhra, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Bihar and West Bengal. These are predominantly rice eating states which is devoid of carotene.

Vitamin-D

Vitamin D is synthesized by sunlight. Vitamin D is essential for bone growth.



Vitamin D is otherwise known as 'sunshine vitamin' as it can be synthesized from sunlight by our body.

Daily requirements: 400 IU

Sources

Generated in the skin by action of ultra violet rays of sunlight

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